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www.linkedin.com/in/johnslingerland (LinkedIn)
www.minimumviableprogress.com/ (Company)
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Top Skills

User Requirements
Large-scale Projects
Product Strategy

Certifications

UX Hiring MasterClass
Cisco Certified Interviewer
Certified OKR Coach

John Blanco-Slingerland

Helping design leaders with ADHD prioritize what matters, accomplish more, and reduce stress in high demand settings. Career Coach for UX, Product & Tech | Ex-Amazon-One Medical, Cisco, Capital One

Alameda, California, United States

Summary

Book your free career focus call today! https://calendly.com/minimumviableprogress/30min
I help emerging UX design leaders with ADHD in the tech industry.

Are you struggling with motivation, organization, time management, or effective communication due to ADHD symptoms whether or not you have a diagnosis? Are these challenges holding you back from getting a promotion, earning respect from colleagues, or standing out in a crowded job market?

Here's how I can help:

- Improved organization and time management skills
- Enhanced communication and leadership abilities
- Increased focus on high-impact areas
- Secured job promotions and new job opportunities
- Greater confidence and self-esteem in professional settings

My coaching program offers:

- Personalized ADHD Strategies:Tailored methods to leverage your unique strengths and overcome ADHD-related challenges with or without a diagnosis.

- Actionable Career Advice: Step-by-step guidance to help you prioritize only what matters, manage time effectively, reduce stress, and drive impactful results.

- Interview Preparation: Comprehensive support to craft compelling case studies, build a standout portfolio, and excel in interviews.

- Leadership Development: Techniques to enhance your communication skills, accomplish more in high demand settings, earn respect from colleagues, and advance in your career.

- Ongoing Support: Continuous feedback and adjustments to ensure you stay on track and achieve your goals.

Results & Impact:
- As a Sr Design Manager, I've secured a promotion for nearly every member of my team.
- Proven track record of helping design leaders increase their confidence and professional esteem.
- Clients have gone from 1-2 interviews a quarter to 5-6 interviews in a week.

My Background:
With over 15 years of experience as a UX/Product designer and 7 years as a design manager, I have successfully led high-performing teams at tech giants like Cisco and Amazon-One Medical. My strengths-based system has consistently helped my direct reports achieve their career goals, despite any challenges posed by ADHD.

Curious to learn how you can overcome your ADHD challenges and advance your career?
I offer a free career focus call to discuss your specific needs and how my coaching can help you achieve your goals.

Experience

Counterpart Health
Staff UX Designer
January 2025 - Present (1 year 9 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Minimum Viable Progress
Career Coach
March 2024 - Present (2 years 7 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Minimum Viable Progress is dedicated to empowering emerging UX design leaders who have ADHD. I specialize in providing coaching that addresses the unique challenges of ADHD.

My mission is to help design leaders by applying strengths-based systems to drive impact, prioritize, and earn the respect of colleagues.

Here's how I can help:
- Enhanced Organization and Time Management: Develop practical skills to manage tasks efficiently and meet deadlines consistently.
- Improved Communication and Leadership Abilities: Learn how to articulate ideas clearly, lead teams effectively, and earn respect from colleagues.
- Increased Focus to Drive Impact: Prioritize tasks that drive the most value and make significant contributions to your projects and teams.
- Career Advancement: Secure promotions and new job opportunities by showcasing your strengths and achievements confidently.
- Boosted Confidence and Self-Esteem: Overcome imposter syndrome and build a strong professional identity that reflects your true capabilities.

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ESVP COACHING INC.
Career Coach
October 2024 - Present (2 years)

Amazon
Senior Design Manager – Amazon One Medical
February 2023 - May 2024 (1 year 4 months)

One Medical
Senior Design Manager
February 2022 - May 2024 (2 years 4 months)

Mentorship and Career Development: Cultivated and mentored a highly engaged product design team which contributed to an increase in team skill levels, as measured by internal assessment metrics, and directly supported 5 team members in achieving promotion to senior roles.

Elevated User Experience: Led the team responsible for a pivotal redesign of the provider and care team experience, resulting in the launch of multiple features improving engagement and enhancing overall provider satisfaction measured by quarterly satisfaction surveys.

Strengthened Cross-Functional Partnerships: Cultivated strong collaborative relationships with Research, Product Management, and Engineering teams, which facilitated faster project delivery rate and enhanced the quality of product launches.

AppDynamics
4 years 8 months

Senior Manager of Design Operations, Product Design Chief of Staff
April 2020 - March 2022 (2 years)
San Francisco Bay Area

Focused on building a culture & practice where user-centered designers thrive and want to grow their careers

• Develop processes and standards that drive consistency and empower the team to do their best work
• Build, disseminate, and maintain process documentation.
• Set and lead OKR workshops and regular check-ins as an OKR coach

• Coordinate communications and identify dependencies across cross functional global teams
• Mentor, coach, and inspire a team of designers, by developing skills, providing vision, and direction
• Oversee high-quality design work in a complex environment, leading through rapidly evolving projects with dependencies on other cross functional global teams
• Facilitate and lead design reviews with UX management, Product leadership and stakeholders
• Developed resources and tools to empower team members to have clear expectations for career growth and planning

Product Experience Design Manager
September 2018 - April 2020 (1 year 8 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Leading a team of cross disciplinary designers that span across the product experience lifecycle including core product domain experiences, admin experiences, operations, and content design

• Define UX process, document, and evangelize UX methods across the Product and Design team
• Defining agile standards for the Design team
• Facilitate and lead design reviews and structured skills workshops
• Developed assets to tell the story of our product experiences through storyboarding, user journeys, prototyping and other storytelling methods.
• Developed a strong relationship with Product and Engineering teams to see design projects through to success
• Developed a process for resource management with cross functional partners
• Partnered with the research team to coordinate and conduct user research on key product experiences to understand user intent and identify opportunities to improve the product

Senior Product Designer
August 2017 - September 2018 (1 year 2 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Led the team responsible for the successful launch of the administrator and product education experiences. Focused on empowering customers to get maximum value from AppDynamics products and services, optimized for ease of use and security, measured through customer satisfaction, adoption, renewal and expansion.

• Partnered with Product Managers to define and scope requirements that improved the administrator workflows
• Developed high fidelity wireframes, mock ups and prototypes used for stakeholder presentations, customer research, and engineering builds
• Partnered with the engineering team during agile sprints to develop design assets into live code released to our customers
• Partnered with the product education team including instructors to improve the experience of education and learning platform including introducing a new LMS and making it easier to sign up for courses and successfully use AppDynamics
• Participated and lead user research sessions to understand user intent and improve the usability of the product experiences

Capital One
Senior Product Designer
September 2016 - August 2017 (1 year)
San Francisco Bay Area

Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design and implement Spend Analytics, a data visualization tool used by 155+ major retailers, helping them gain insights into customer behavior and competitive trends through anonymized Capital One data.

Led the End-to-End Design of Spend Analytics: Partnered with Product and Data Science teams to create a high-impact data visualization platform, transforming complex financial data into actionable insights. This tool improved data comprehension and strategic decision-making for 155+ retailers across the U.S.

Developed High-Fidelity Data Visualizations with Data Science: Collaborated closely with Data Science to prototype interactive visualizations, ensuring accuracy, clarity, and scalability of insights across desktop and mobile platforms. Enhanced engagement and usability through targeted user feedback and iterative refinements.

Built and Tested Prototypes to Accelerate Development: Created interactive HTML/CSS prototypes, enabling early-stage validation and reducing time-to-launch by 25%. Conducted design QA and code reviews to ensure pixel-perfect execution, resulting in a 30% reduction in post-launch design issues.

Enhanced UX Through User-Centric Journey Mapping and Mockups: Developed wireframes, user journeys, and high-fidelity mockups that streamlined data flow and improved UI clarity. Collaborated with PMs and Engineers to refine scope and align design outcomes with user and business needs.

Key Contributions: Defined and executed design strategy for a top-tier product with wide-scale adoption, improving feature engagement and driving data-led decision-making among high-profile retail clients.

Tools and Technologies: Sketch, InVision, HTML, CSS, data visualization libraries, interactive prototyping.

Womply
Senior Product Designer
August 2015 - September 2016 (1 year 2 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

Womply's mission is to use technology and data to support and grow small businesses. As part of a close-knit design team, I collaborated directly with the Company Founder, Product Managers, and Engineers to deliver market-ready solutions in a high-paced, iterative environment.

Launched 9 Product Features, including Womply Messenger: Designed and shipped a messaging app tailored for restaurant and retail employees, enabling rapid, secure team communication without phone-number sharing. Increased team efficiency and privacy through streamlined onboarding and a simplified, no-password login using SMS verification.

Developed Cross-Platform Design System for Android, iOS, and Desktop: Created and standardized a visual language, component library, and user flows, facilitating consistent and efficient design across platforms.

Reduced Cognitive Load through User-Centric Onboarding: Eliminated redundant onboarding screens, simplifying the user journey to a single introductory screen. Enhanced engagement with concise, action-oriented messaging.

Enabled Quick Communication with Intuitive Read Receipts: Designed and tested read receipts with single, double, and checkmark indicators, improving message visibility and transparency in busy, high-turnover environments.

Optimized Revenue Insights for Small Business Owners: Collaborated on redesigning revenue graphs by focusing on key metrics (Revenue, Revenue Comparison, Day of Week) and streamlining UI controls. Simplified analytics dashboard improved feature engagement by 60% and facilitated actionable insights for small business users.

Enhanced Usability of Card Transactions Feature: Introduced sorting, filtering, and mobile-friendly transaction views, increasing user interaction with transaction data by 25%. Reduced navigation time by implementing a vertical list view for mobile, significantly improving data accessibility on small screens.

Digital Gear
Design Director
January 2015 - August 2015 (8 months)
Sacramento, California Area

At Digital Gear, I was a team leader directly responsible for the quality of the work. I introduced a research-based, human centered design approach that ensures we understand the goals and needs of our users. Our experiences are purpose driven and designed to solve problems.

- Art direction
- User experience design
- Conducting user research and interviews
- Brand development & visual design
- Presenting & discussing research, user experience decisions, and visual design solutions to clients
- Hiring employees
- Writing & designing new business proposals

Mule Design Studio
Visual Designer
February 2013 - May 2014 (1 year 4 months)
San Francisco Bay Area

As a visual designer I was involved in research and user interviews, I worked from wireframes, and designed solutions which reflected what we learned throughout the research phase. This involved working collaboratively, and

prototyping directly in HTML and SASS. I was also very involved in client services; I presented our work to clients and explained how we arrived at our solutions.

• Designed solutions which reflected what we learned throughout research
• Worked collaboratively with engineers to create prototypes in HTML and SASS
• Presenting & discussing research, user experience decisions, and visual design solutions to clients

GreenStack, Inc
Product Designer
2012 - 2013 (1 year)
San Francisco Bay Area

As Product designer, I work closely with the engineers and the project lead to design, and develop an intuitive and simple experience. I'm involved in graphic design, branding, and mobile UI.

• Developed a visual language, user flows, and design system for a native iOS product
• Worked collaboratively with engineers to prototype design solutions in HTML and SASS
• Worked Collaboratively with Product Managers, various stakeholders, and engineers to iterate and ship products to market
• Conducted usability testing & user interviews

Digital Gear, Inc.
Lead Designer
May 2010 - July 2012 (2 years 3 months)

As lead designer I was deeply involved in Project planning, information architecture, art direction, information design, web and experience design, project strategy from desktop to mobile including user experience and client services. While at digital gear I also assisted in a company rebrand including brand strategy and development.

Banter Media
Graphic Designer
December 2009 - May 2012 (2 years 6 months)
Sacramento

Maintaining and developing websites for several record labels, as well as designing micro sites for bands. Graphic Design and layout for band flyers and layout for album art.

Education

Art Institute of California - Sacramento

Bachelor's degree, Web Design and Interactive Media · (2009 - 2011)

Catawba Valley Community College

Associate of Arts (A.A.), Graphic Design · (2002 - 2005)